

Huailu Li

huailu@bu.edu · +65-97358812

Singapore Permanent Resident · Chinese Citizen

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Research Fellow, IREUS, National University of Singapore	2025–Present
Associate Professor, School of Economics, Fudan University	2022–2025
Lecturer, Department of Economics, Nanyang Technological University	2021–2022
Assistant Professor, School of Economics, Fudan University	2014–2021

OTHER ACADEMIC POSITIONS AND AFFILIATIONS

Visiting Research Fellow, IREUS, National University of Singapore	2024–2025
Research Fellow, IZA	2023–Present
Research Affiliate, IZA	2017–2023
Research Fellow, Shanghai Institute of International Finance and Economics	2018–2020

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Boston University	2014
<i>Dissertation: Understanding the Commercial Sex Market in Singapore</i>	

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of Crime; Household Finance; Labor Economics

PUBLICATIONS

1. “The Effects of Policy Interventions to Limit Illegal Moneylending”, Kaiwen Leong, **Huailu Li**, Nicola Pavanini and Christoph Walsh. **Journal of Financial Economics** (2024).
2. “Lending the Unbanked: Relational Contracting in Singapore’s Unlicensed Moneylending Market”, Kevin Lang, Kaiwen Leong, **Huailu Li** and Haibo Xu. **The Review of Economics and Statistics** (2022).
3. “Law Enforcement and Bargaining Over Illicit Drug Prices: Structural Evidence from a Gang’s Ledger”, Kaiwen Leong, **Huailu Li**, Marc Rysman and Christoph Walsh. **Journal of the European Economic Association** (2022).
4. “Does Competition Eliminate Discrimination? Evidence from the Commercial Sex Market in Singapore”, **Huailu Li**, Kevin Lang and Kaiwen Leong. **The Economic Journal** (2018).

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

1. “Re-examining Investor Sentiment and Stock Returns: A Replication and Extension of Baker & Wurgler (2006)”, Kaiwen Leong, Dan Li, **Huailu Li**, Chuangwei Peng and Zhanyu Xu. **Economic Inquiry** (2025).
2. “Cheating Amongst Youth Offenders: How Peers and Their Social Status Influence Cheating”, Kaiwen Leong, **Huailu Li** and Sharon Xuejing Zuo. **Economic Inquiry** (2023).
3. “Cheap Talk With Outside Options: A Lab Experiment”, Kaiwen Leong, Dan Li, **Huailu Li** and Haibo Xu. **Singapore Economic Review** (2022).
4. “Unlicensed Moneylending Market: Relational Contracting between Borrowers and Lenders”, Kaiwen Leong, Dan Li, **Huailu Li** and Haibo Xu. **Singapore Economic Review** (2022).
5. “Teacher Team-Based Incentives: Evidence from a Natural Experiment in a Middle School”, Kaiwen Leong, **Huailu Li**, Dan Li and Yuchen Xie. **Singapore Economic Review** (2021).

WORKING PAPERS

1. “Fragility of Social Norm: Theory and Evidence from a Youth Correction Center”, with Kaiwen Leong and Linh T. To. (Submitted.)
2. “Risk for Men, Discounts for Women: Gendered Advice and Pricing in Retail Brokerage”, with Sumit Agarwal, Kevin Lang, Kaiwen Leong and Zhanyu Xu.
3. “Network Density and Strategic Behavior in Collective Action: Evidence from Indonesian Protest Participants”, with Kaiwen Leong.
4. “Life Cycle of the Carbon Footprint: Evidence from Big Data in Singapore”, with Sumit Agarwal and Wenlan Qian.
5. “The Cost of Coordinating Collusion in an Illegal Money Lending Cartel: Evidence from Countrywide Digitization of Citizenry Information”, with Kaiwen Leong, Nicola Pavanini and Christopher Walsh.
6. “Systemic Discrimination Among Large Chinese Employers”, with Kevin Lang, Kaiwen Leong and Dan Li.

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. “Peer Effect and Misconduct in Youth Corrections”, with Kaiwen Leong.
2. “Public and Private Incentives: Evidence from a Youth Correction Center”, with Kaiwen Leong and Linh T. To.
3. “Forever Trapped: New Evidence from Heavily Debt Borrowers”, with Kaiwen Leong.

RESEARCH GRANTS

- *Singapore Social Mobility and Networks Study (SMNS)*, Quantedge, SGD 10 million, Principal Investigator, 2026–2034.
- *Financial Globalization, Economic Growth, and Crisis: Insights from Chinese History*, NSF China, RMB 450,000, 2023–2026.
- *Construction and Quantitative Analysis of Historical Data on Chinese National Governance and Long-Term Economic Development*, NSF China, RMB 2.36 million, 2020–2024.
- *Research on the Reputation Mechanism of Credit Rating Agencies in the Chinese Bond Market*, NSF China, RMB 480,000, 2020–2023.
- *Do Inmates Exhibit Loss Aversion? Evidence from Singapore’s Reformative Training Center*, MOE AcRF Tier 1, SGD 40,000, 2019–2021.
- Gaofeng Frontier Research Grant, RMB 100,000, 2018–2019.
- *Relational Contracting in the Singapore Back Alley Banking Market*, Singapore MOE AcRF Tier 1, SGD 57,880, 2015–2017.
- Start-up Grant, RMB 200,000, 2014–2017.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Courses: Advanced Microeconomic Theory; Econometrics; Labor Economics; Economic Analysis: A Python Application; Economics of Data Analytics: An Application to Policy Evaluation.

Undergraduate Courses: Applied Microeconomics; Introduction to Econometrics; Labor Economics; Quantitative Analysis and Software Applications.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Consultant, Adullam Life Counselling (NGO), Singapore	2023–Present
Research Scholar, Economic Growth Centre, NTU, Singapore	2023–Present
Consultant, Singapore Prisons Service	2021–Present
Consultant, Singapore Business Federation	2012–2013
Consultant, World Bank	2011–2012

SELECTED CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

- Seminar Presentation, Department of Finance, University of Queensland, March 2026.
- Seminar Presentation, School of Economics, University of Queensland, March 2026.
- Seminar Presentation, University of Melbourne, March 2026.
- Invited Seminar, Department of Social Work, National University of Singapore, February 2026.
- Singapore Economic Review Conference, Singapore, 2026, 2019, 2017, 2013.
- Invited Presentation, NBER Summer Institute, Economics of Crime Session, 2025.
- Price Theory Summer Camp, Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago, 2018.
- China Meeting of the Econometric Society, 2018.
- Seminar Talk, UC Irvine, 2018.
- CSWEP's CeMENT National Workshop, Philadelphia, 2018.
- AEA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, 2018.
- NBER Summer Institute, Boston, 2017.
- SOLE-EALE World Meetings, Montreal, 2015.
- China Women Economists International Workshop, Beijing, 2015.
- Asian Annual Meeting of the Econometric Society, Singapore, 2013.
- Singapore Economic Roundtable, 2012.
- Singapore National SME Convention, 2012.

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Associate Editor, *Singapore Economic Review*

2024–Present

BOOK REVIEW

Li, Huailu. Review of Hossein Jalilian, *Costs and Benefits of Cross-Country Labor Migration in the GMS*. *Singapore Economic Review*, 2014, 59(05), 1480004-1–1480004-4.

MEDIA AND NEWSPAPER ARTICLES

Li, Huailu, Kevin Lang and Kaiwen Leong. "Competition alone will not eliminate discrimination." *Vox*, 28 August 2015.

Li, Huailu and Kaiwen Leong. "Direct, real impact of SME policies." *The Business Times*, p. 8, 26 February 2013.